

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Paralegal role in James Fisher and Sons' Maritime Transport Division because it sits at the intersection of commercial contract work and regulatory compliance, two areas I have built real experience in and want to develop further in a permanent in-house role.

My year at BCLP gave me the closest experience I have to this kind of work. In the International Arbitration team I became the only junior supporting the team in the weeks before a major procedural deadline, coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and liaising directly with the client on required materials. In Real Estate Disputes I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and managed large volumes of documents across several matters running simultaneously. Both rotations involved drafting, deadline management and keeping structured case files under pressure, which maps directly to what this role describes.

My contract review work at Adobe sharpened my eye for the kind of issues an in-house legal team cares about. I reviewed and amended software licensing agreements, flagged data-processing and confidentiality provisions, and liaised with sales and international business teams to resolve contractual queries. I learned to read a contract with commercial risk in mind rather than just legal accuracy, and that shift in framing is something I have carried into every legal role since. At Q-Legal I managed a data-privacy matter from initial instruction through to a formal written advice letter, researching UK GDPR obligations for a data-driven start-up and translating statutory requirements into practical recommendations the client could actually use.

The maritime context is new to me, but the underlying legal tasks are not. Handling contractual and compliance issues, supporting senior counsel, drafting documents and managing matters through to resolution are things I have done across dispute resolution, commercial contracts and regulatory advice. An in-house division team means direct exposure to how legal risk is managed as a business decision, and that is where I want to be.

I would welcome the chance to discuss my application in more detail.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva